

RRB SECTION CONTROLLER — MASTER INTELLIGENCE REPORT

The complete exam dossier + content-generation blueprint

Prepared: 05 October 2026 · For the CBT on 12–13 October 2026 · Corpus: 4 authentic shift papers (400 Qs) + official CEN notification + verified cutoff data

PART 1 — EXAM IDENTITY (verified facts, no folklore)

Item	Fact	Source
Exam	RRB Section Controller, CEN 03/2026 (119 posts)	RRB notice 11.09.2026
CBT date	12–13 October 2026 (your exam: 12 Oct)	RRB notice
Pattern	100 Q / 100 marks / 120 min	Official CEN
Paper shape	Single section, interleaved question types (verified against the official response-sheet export); components: Analytical & Mathematical 60 · Logical 20 · Mental 20	Official CEN + platform export
Marking	+1 correct, –1/3 wrong , 0 unattempted	Official CEN
Language	15 languages (English/Hindi + 13 regional)	Official CEN
Normalisation	Applied across shifts (equal-difficulty equating)	Official CEN
Min qualifying	UR/EWS 40%, OBC/SC 30%, ST 25% (only a floor; real cutoff >>)	Official CEN
Next stages	CBAT → DV → Medical (A-2)	Official CEN
CBAT	8× vacancies shortlisted; T-score ≥ 42 in EVERY battery (no category relaxation); 30% of final merit ; no negative marking	Official CEN
Final merit	70% CBT + 30% CBAT	Official CEN

Reality check (this defines everything): In the 2025 cycle (same syllabus, same blueprint), UR cutoffs for CBAT shortlist ran **89.15–98.35 / 100** (Ranchi 89.15, Ajmer ~90–97, Chandigarh 98.35, Bengaluru 95.79). With 119 posts and ~8× shortlist, the effective UR target is ≈ **92–96 net**. This is a **topping exam, not a passing exam**: you must capture ~95 of 100 marks with near-zero accuracy loss. Negative marking (–1/3) means every blind guess is expensive.

Score math that should drive your whole strategy:

- Net = Correct – (Wrong ÷ 3). 95C/3W → 94.0. 90C/10W → 86.7. The difference between cutoff-level and top is *accuracy*, not knowledge volume.
- Every topic you skip costs you; every question you rush and miss costs 1.33 marks net vs. leaving it.

PART 2 — WHAT THE 400 AUTHENTIC PYQs ACTUALLY SHOW (11–12 Feb 2026, all 4 shifts)

Full corpus: 4 shift papers × 100 Q (Adda247 solved edition + raw papers), parsed and classified programmatically.

2.1 Observed paper shape (avg per shift)

The live paper runs as a **single section with interleaved question types** (verified against the official response-sheet export of 12-Feb S1 — no grouped blocks; treat it as a type sweep, not a section order). Composition per shift:

| Component | Qs | Content observed |

|---|---|---|

| **Analytical & Mathematical** | ~60 | Arithmetic-dominant + algebra/geometry/mensuration/trigonometry + statistics & probability + 8–10 DI/statistics questions |

| **Logical Capability** | ~20 | Reading comprehension (3 passages × 5 = **15 Qs — the single biggest Logical block**), syllogism, binary logic, blood relations, puzzles/seating, assumptions |

| **Mental Reasoning** | ~20 | Series (number/alphabet/mixed), analogy & pair-patterns, coding-decoding, ranking,

2.2 Topic frequency (my classification of all 400 Qs)

Topic	Avg/shift	Topic	Avg/shift
RC (incl. vocab)	15	Ratio/proportion	~5–6
Percentages	~7	Number system/HCF-LCM	~5–6
Mensuration	~7	Ranking/series/symbol sets	~5+5
Profit-loss/discount	~6	Seating/puzzles	~3–4
DI (table/pie/line/bar)	~7–9	Averages	~3
Statistics (mean/median/mode/SD)	~3–5	Probability	~2–3
Time-work/pipes	~2–3	TSD (incl. trains/boats)	~2–3
Ages	~1–2	Algebra/simplification	~4–6
AP/GP	~1–2	Trigonometry/heights	~1–2
Geometry (lines/angles/circles/triangles)	~4–6	Coding-decoding	~2–3

2.3 THE BIGGEST FINDING — template recycling

RRB reuses the **same question skeletons across shifts with renumbered values**. Verified duplicates inside this single 2-day window:

- HCF×LCM product → other number (Q88 S1, Q3 S2, Q29 S1-12Feb — identical stem, new numbers)
- Cylinder: circumference of base + height → capacity in litres (Q16 S1, Q48 S2, Q3 S1-12Feb, Q68 S2-12Feb)
- Sum of two positive numbers + product → positive difference (Q51 S1, Q65 S2, Q38 S1-12Feb, Q74 S2-12Feb)
- Father-son age template (Q3, Q10)
- Profit% = loss% template (Q11, Q61 — the "same % on two prices" family)
- RC question set is always the same 5 archetypes: main idea / supporting detail / application / structure / tone+vocab
- Number-symbol series counting, direct-proportion extension, inverse proportion, successive discounts...

Conclusion: mastery = the template library + speed arithmetic, not "more topics". The content below is therefore organised by template, not by textbook chapter.

2.4 Difficulty & timing profile (from shift analyses + paper audit)

- Overall difficulty: Moderate; maths slightly calculative; reasoning scoring.
- Good attempts by real candidates: 70–85 of 100. Toppers: 90+. This gap is pure speed + accuracy discipline.
- Time budget reality: 120 min / 100 Q = 72 s/Q average, but RC passages eat 8–10 min; maths heavyweights (mensuration, DI) eat 90–120 s each. You survive only with a per-question time discipline + the shortcut arsenal.

PART 3 — THE WINNING STRATEGY (what "topping" requires)

1. **Answer order (type sweep — A/B-tested by the plan's W-03 vs S-17):** the paper interleaves types, so the sweep = mental → logical → maths. Front-load where accuracy is highest and time cost lowest, then grind maths with full attention, keeping an 8–10 min review buffer. Verify against your own mock data — the W-03/S-17 comparison decides your order.
2. **The –1/3 discipline:** attempt everything you can solve within its time budget; guessing EV decides: 4-way blind = $1/4 - 3/4 \times 1/3 = 0$ (never); one option killed = $1/3 - 2/3 \times 1/3 = +1/9$ (final-minutes leftovers only); two killed = $1/2 - 1/2 \times 1/3 = +1/3$ (always). **Rule: compute → eliminate → guess; never blind.**
3. **Accuracy engineering:** the content modules each end with a "TRAP" field because the –1/3 tax is the real exam. Units (cm vs m), "not" in the question, % vs number, reading direction (left/right), last-step slips are how 90 becomes 80.
4. **Speed infrastructure:** squares to 40, cubes to 20, fraction↔percent table ($1/2 \dots 1/30$), tables to 30, approximation rules ($\pi \approx 22/7$ vs 3.14 decision), digit-sum checks for multiplication/addition. These are drilled in Part A of the content.

5. **CBAT is not the 12-Oct exam but is 30% of the job:** 5 batteries (Intelligence 35Q/5min, Selective Attention 30Q/8min, Spatial Scanning 40Q/8min, Information Ordering 25Q, Personality 35Q), T $\geq$ 42 each, no negative marking. One-page primer + daily 10-min drill habit is enough for now; the CBT score gates entry to it (8 $\times$ shortlist), so CBT mastery is the priority.

PART 4 — CONTENT ARCHITECTURE (the "one book to top it")

Format contract for EVERY module (this is what makes it readable as a single source):

[Topic] – [N] Qs in paper

UNDERSTAND $\rightarrow$ the concept in plain words, 3–6 lines, no jargon without definition

THE TRICK $\rightarrow$ the fastest exam-hall method, step-by-step, WHY it works (1 line)

WORKED TEMPLATES $\rightarrow$ 2–3 solved PYQ-pattern questions (exam wording, exam numbers)

TRAPS $\rightarrow$ the specific mistakes that cost $\sim$ 1/3 in this topic

SPEED DRILL $\rightarrow$ 10 PYQ-style Qs with answers (answers verified)

Book structure:

- **Part 0** The game: exam anatomy, scoring math, attempt strategy, day plan
- **Part A** Speed toolkit: arithmetic infrastructure (tables, squares/cubes, fraction-% map, approximation, digit checks)
- **Part B** Analytical & Mathematical Capability (60 Q): 34 template modules across arithmetic, algebra, geometry/mensuration, trigonometry, statistics/probability, DI
- **Part C** Logical Capability (20 Q): syllogism, binary logic, blood relations, clocks-calendars, assumptions, puzzles/seating, **RC method with the 5 fixed question archetypes**
- **Part D** Mental Reasoning (20 Q): series families, analogy/pair-patterns, coding-decoding, ranking/arrangement, number-symbol sets, mathematical operations
- **Part E** Exam-day execution: minute-by-minute plan, skip rules, review protocol
- **Part F** CBAT primer (post-CBT stage, 30% merit)
- **Question banks** 650 PYQ-pattern drills + a 50-Q RC supplement (file 30), answers verified

PART 5 — GENERATION BLUEPRINT FOR DEEPSEEK V4.1 FLASH (orchestration contract)

How the content is produced (I orchestrate; you can regenerate/extend any module with DeepSeek V4.1 Flash using these exact prompts):

1. **One module = one prompt.** Never ask for "the whole maths section" — output quality collapses. Each prompt is self-contained: topic, exact question count observed in PYQs, 2–3 real PYQ examples embedded, format contract above, difficulty mix (60% exam-level, 25% easier, 15% harder-trap), and the ban on derivation dumps (solutions $\leq$ 5 lines, shortcut first).
2. **Master system prompt (paste once per chat):**

You are writing the definitive preparation book for RRB Section Controller CBT (CEN 03/2026): 100 Q, 120 min, sections AMC 60 / Logical 20 / Mental Reasoning 20, +1/-% marking. Audience: candidate targeting 95+/100.
Rules: (1) Every module uses the fixed format UNDERSTAND $\rightarrow$ THE TRICK $\rightarrow$ WORKED TEMPLATES $\rightarrow$ TRAPS $\rightarrow$ SPEED DRILL. (2) Explain WHY a trick works in one line — the candidate must understand, not memorise. (3) Solutions $\leq$ 5 lines, shortcut-first. (4) Numbers must be exam-realistic (answers are usually clean integers or neat fractions; $\pi=22/7$ or 3.14 as stated). (5) Every module ends with TRAPS — the exact mistakes that cost marks in this topic. (6) No filler, no motivation, no restating the syllabus. Output plain text, no commentary.

1. **Verification protocol (non-negotiable, mine):** every generated question's answer is re-computed with Python before it enters the book; schema checks (4 options, single answer, format fields present); near-duplicate stems deduped; anything failing gets one correction round, then drop-replace.
 2. **Batch map (what gets generated in what order):** Part A (1 module) $\rightarrow$ B arithmetic (8 modules) $\rightarrow$ B advanced maths (6) $\rightarrow$ B statistics/probability (2) $\rightarrow$ B DI (3) $\rightarrow$ C (7 modules) $\rightarrow$ D (5 modules) $\rightarrow$ question banks per part $\rightarrow$ Part E/F (I write directly).
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PART 6 — RISK REGISTER (what usually kills candidates)

1. **Studying the wrong syllabus** — GA/current-affairs material floods the internet for this exam; the CBT has NO General Awareness. Every GA minute is stolen from the 60-mark maths block.
 2. **Confusing departmental SC papers (2023/2024 Raipur-div exams on GRS/SWR/signals) with the CEN pattern** — the internet mixes them; only the Feb-2026 CEN 04/2025 papers match your exam.
 3. **RC under-preparation** — 15 marks, needs a *method* (read Qs first, map structure, answer archetypes), not reading practice.
 4. **Lengthy mensuration/DI questions** — the 90–120 s items; without approximation discipline they destroy the clock.
 5. **Guessing culture** — $-1/3$ punishes it; the content drills the "eliminate-2-then-guess" rule.
 6. **Normalization complacency** — score the raw 92+, don't plan around shifts.
 7. **Exam-day ops** — city slip ~2 Oct, e-call letter ~8 Oct, Aadhaar-unlock biometric entry; carry printout; reach early. (Logistics, zero marks, but zero-cost insurance.)
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PART 7 — WHAT WAS VERIFIED vs. WHAT IS ESTIMATE

Verified (primary/official or direct document): exam date, pattern, syllabus wording, marking, CBAT rules, final-merit weights, cutoffs 2025 cycle, 400-Q corpus classification, template recycling examples.

Estimate/secondary: exact question-count per topic (my classification of PYQ corpus — solid but heuristic), "expected" cutoff bands, battery timing minutiae for CBAT (from test-prep documentation of RDSO pattern, not official PDF).

PART 8 — DELIVERY RECORD (updated 07 Oct 2026 — post-audit rebuild)

Deliverable 1 — this report. All Parts 1–7 above.

Deliverable 2 — the Master Book (content/ → compiled MASTER_BOOK.md, 19,499 lines · 353-page PDF):

- **Strategy layer:** 00 The Game (scoring math, guessing EV, 120-min map) · 17 Exam-Day execution · 18 CBAT Primer · 19 the 7-Day Plan · 28 Weapon Cards (37 last-day reflexes).
- **Concept modules (17):** 01 Speed Toolkit · 02 Percentages · 03 P&L-Interest · 04 Ratio-Average-Age · 05 Time-Work · 06 TSD · 07 Numbers-Simplification · 08 Geometry · 09 Mensuration-Trig · 10 Statistics-Probability · 11 Data Interpretation · 12 Syllogism-Binary-Assumptions · 13 Blood-Clocks-Calendars · 14 Puzzles-Seating · 15 Reading Comprehension · 16 Mental Reasoning · 29 Algebra Mini-Module (equations, identities, AP/GP, coordinate geometry) — every module: UNDERSTAND → THE TRICK (why it works) → WORKED TEMPLATES (PYQ-anchored) → TRAPS → SPEED DRILL.
- **Question banks (650 Q):** 21 Arithmetic-1 (120) · 22 Arithmetic-2 (120) · 23 Geometry-Stats (120) · 24 DI (10 sets, 50) · 25 Logical (120) · 26 Mental (120) — every question inline: **Answer** → **Trick** → **Solution** → **Trap**; answer letters machine-balanced (~25% each after the audit shuffle); zero duplicate stems.
- **Real papers:** 20 the fully-solved 11-Feb paper (100 Q; RC passages restored; inline Answer→Trick→Solution→Trap) · 27 three real-paper mocks (11-Feb S2, 12-Feb S1, 12-Feb S2) — **260 of 300 questions fully solved (Trick + Solution + Trap), every RC passage embedded under each of its 5 questions, and all unanswerable items [!]-marked with exact skip lists in the plan.** Plus **30 RC Supplement — 10 fresh passages / 50 Qs fully solved.**
- Verification: three layers — each generating agent's own Python battery; independent audits (bank answer values re-checked after the letter shuffle: 0 mismatches; all 260 mock solutions cross-checked to the official key letters: 0 mismatches; every module drill re-parsed and re-computed); and the app itself passes an end-to-end automated UI suite (34/34).

How to use: open MASTER_BOOK.md; start with 00 + 19 (the plan), then follow the 7-day schedule: concept modules Mon–Fri, full-paper mocks Sat/Sun, Weapon Cards the night before and the morning of the exam. The book is self-sufficient — no coaching, no external PDFs needed.